

## Lab 3: Data Analysis Challenge

**Time:** 30 minutes

**What you need:** Claude.ai + Claude in Excel (if installed)

**Files provided:** `q4-sales-data.csv` , `competitor-intel.txt`

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### The Scenario

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You're preparing for a Monday morning leadership meeting. Your VP wants: 1. A quick read on Q4 sales performance 2. A competitive battle card the sales team can use 3. To know if any reps need coaching

You have 30 minutes. Go.

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### Part 1: Analyze Sales Data in Claude.ai (10 min)

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1. Open a conversation in Claude.ai (or use your Project from Lab 2)
2. Upload `q4-sales-data.csv`

**Start broad, then drill down:**

"Analyze this Q4 sales data. Give me the headline numbers: total revenue, quota attainment, and top/bottom performers."

⚠ **STOP — Verify Before You Proceed**

**This is the most important step in the entire lab.**

Before you do anything else with Claude's output:

1. **Open the CSV** in Excel or a text editor
2. **Spot-check 3 numbers** Claude reported against the raw data
3. **Manually calculate one total** (e.g., add up Sarah Chen's revenue across 3 months)
4. **Does it match?** If yes, continue. If not, tell Claude: "Your total for Sarah Chen doesn't match the data. Recalculate."

**Why this matters:** AI can hallucinate numbers that sound plausible but are completely fabricated. A company recently discovered their AI had been

inventing analytics data for 3 months — their VP made territory decisions based on fake numbers, and their CFO presented fabricated insights to the board. Nobody checked until it was too late.

**The rule: Never send AI-generated numbers to anyone without verifying them against the source data first.**

**Checkpoint:** You verified at least 3 numbers. Write down which ones you checked and whether they matched.

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Now continue:

"Which regions are trending up vs. down month-over-month? Any reps I should be concerned about?"

**Verify again:** Pick one region's trend claim and check it against the monthly numbers in the CSV.

Then create your deliverable:

"Write a 3-paragraph Q4 Performance Summary I can paste into an email to my VP. Lead with the good news, flag the risks, and end with 2 recommendations for Q1."

**Checkpoint:** You have a verified, email-ready summary. Every number in it traces back to the source data.

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## Part 2: Competitive Battle Card (10 min)

Upload `competitor-intel.txt` to the same conversation.

**Prompt 1 — Structure the data:**

"Create a comparison matrix of us vs. the 3 competitors. Columns: Pricing, Strengths, Weaknesses, Win Strategy. Make it an artifact."

## Prompt 2 — Make it actionable:

"Now create a one-page Competitive Battle Card for our sales reps. For each competitor, give: 2-sentence positioning, top objection they'll hear, and our counter. Keep it scannable — reps will read this on their phone between calls."

## Prompt 3 — Get specific:

"NimbleOps lost us 4 deals last quarter from free tier conversions. Write a 60-second talk track for when a prospect says 'we're already using NimbleOps free tier.'"

**Checkpoint:** You have a battle card artifact and a talk track. Both are print-ready.

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## Part 3: Claude in Excel (10 min)

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If you have Claude in Excel installed:

1. Open `q4-sales-data.csv` in Excel
2. Use Claude in Excel to:

"Add a column calculating each rep's quota attainment percentage"

"Highlight reps who missed quota in any month"

"Create a summary row showing totals and averages"

If you don't have Claude in Excel:

Continue in Claude.ai:

"Based on the sales data, create a formatted table showing each rep's Q4 totals: revenue, quota, attainment %, deals closed, and average deal size. Sort by attainment. Flag anyone below 90%."

"Which rep would benefit most from coaching? What specific metrics support that recommendation?"

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## What You Delivered

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In 30 minutes, you created: - ☐ Q4 Performance Summary (email-ready) - ☐ Competitive Comparison Matrix - ☐ Sales Battle Card (print-ready) - ☐ Competitor-specific talk track - ☐ Rep performance analysis with coaching recommendation

**This is a real Monday morning.** The difference is you did it in 30 minutes instead of 3 hours.

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## The Verification Habit

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The #1 risk with AI-generated analysis is **plausible-sounding numbers that are wrong**. Build this habit now:

| Step | What to Check | How                                                 |
|------|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Totals        | Add a column yourself — does it match?              |
| 2    | Percentages   | Calculate one manually                              |
| 3    | Trends        | Look at the raw monthly numbers                     |
| 4    | Rankings      | Sort the data yourself — same order?                |
| 5    | Outliers      | If Claude flags something unusual, verify it exists |

**If you only remember one thing from today: AI is your analyst, not your auditor. You are the auditor.**

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Tip: Save your best prompts. Next quarter, upload Q1 data and reuse them. The prompts are as valuable as the output.